

ALESSIA PAPINI

Department of Economics, European University Institute
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EDUCATION

- 2025– Ph.D. in Economics, European University Institute
 Supervisors: Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Alexander Ludwig
- 2024–25 Master of Research in Economics, European University Institute
- 2021–23 M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences, Università Bocconi
 Supervisor: Prof. Tommaso Monacelli Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude
- 2018–21 B.A. in Economics, Università degli Studi di Firenze Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Expectation Formation, Fiscal and Monetary Policy

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Fiscal Policy and Household Over-Optimism”

This paper studies whether fiscal policy transmits to the economy through a sentiment channel. Using the ECB Consumer Expectations Survey, I construct individual-level credit-access forecast errors — defined as the difference between a household’s expected credit access formed twelve months earlier and its realized value — and study how these errors respond to a nationwide fiscal regime shift in Italy in February 2021. I document systematic and persistent over-optimism: forecast errors increase by up to 7.8 percent of the survey scale, peaking several months after the announcement before gradually declining. The hump-shaped dynamic is consistent with diagnostic expectations models, suggesting that belief distortions constitute an additional channel of fiscal policy transmission. Finally, I show that over-optimistic beliefs translate into active credit-seeking behavior: a one-unit increase in the forecast error is associated with a 0.56 percentage-point higher probability of applying for a consumer loan in the subsequent quarter.

PUBLICATIONS

Guerini, C., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “Literacy and Financial Education: Private Providers, Public Certification and Political Preferences.” *Italian Economic Journal*, 2024.
[doi:10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1)

Borghi, E., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “European Politicians and Financial Literacy Activism: Does Financial (In)Stability Matter?” *Economics Letters*, 2024.
[doi:10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025– Research Assistant to Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Saverio Simonelli, European University Institute
- 2023–24 Research Assistant to Profs. Donato Masciandaro, Elisa Borghi and Magda Bianco (Bank of Italy), Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi
- 2022–23 Research Assistant to Prof. Tommaso Monacelli, Università Bocconi
- Feb–Apr 2023 Research Intern in Monetary Policy, Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

2025	Bank of Italy Grant for Female Economists
2024	Italian Grant for Master of Research Students, European University Institute
2022	Premio di Laurea Lorenzo Bruni, Università degli Studi di Firenze — Best Undergraduate in Economics, A.Y. 2020/21
2022	Premio America Giovani, UNAI — Full Tuition Waiver. Top 1,000 Italian graduates of A.Y. 2020/21

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fall 2025	Teaching Assistant, <i>Macroeconomics I</i> (PhD), European University Institute <i>Prof. Alexander Ludwig</i>
2024–25	Teaching Assistant, <i>International Economics</i> and <i>Microeconomics</i> , Politecnico di Milano <i>Profs. Giulia Felice and Lucia Tajoli</i>
Feb–Jun 2022	Tutor, TOP Project, Fondazione CIAI — Bocconi University / Harvard University

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, R, L^AT_EX, Python, Gretl, MATLAB, QGIS

Languages: Italian (native), English (C1), French (B1)